

Semester GTM: Executive Summary

A concise version of the full playbook

Internal. Draft.

Operating document. It is not legal, tax, accounting, insurance, privacy, security or accessibility advice. Every figure is a planning assumption or forecast, not an approved price, budget or target.

ASSUMPTION

VERIFIED

DRAFT

INTERNAL

APPROVED

REVIEW

Every statement is labelled. No item in this document is a customer-facing approved claim: no named approver is recorded for any wording.

How to read the labels

Labels apply to a section, a table row or a bullet, not to every sentence. The count is how many label tags appear in this document; legend mentions in code formatting are not counted.

Label	Meaning	Count
VERIFIED	Verified implementation or evidence. Backed by a path in the repository or an evidence id.	0
ASSUMPTION	Planning assumption. A number, rate, timing or price chosen to plan with. Not evidenced.	0
DRAFT	Draft requiring review. Default for anything new.	0
APPROVED	Customer-facing approved claim. Needs a named approver and a register row. None exists today.	0
INTERNAL	Internal-only material. Never to be sent to a customer or prospect as written.	0
REVIEW	Professional review required: counsel, tax, accounting, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility or procurement.	0

Planning assumptions are labelled ASSUMPTION. **Verified claims** are labelled VERIFIED and name their evidence. **Draft and internal items** are labelled DRAFT and INTERNAL. **Customer-facing approved material** is labelled APPROVED and is absent: the count above is zero. **Professional-review items** carry a REVIEW flag naming the profession.

Control	Value
Status	DRAFT, INTERNAL. PLANNING ASSUMPTIONS. NOT APPROVED BY ANY NAMED OWNER.
Owner	Harrison Rubin (interim; counsel, accountant, broker and security assessor unassigned)
Evidence date	2026-10-05 at repository revision 5eba494 plus this branch
Labels used	VERIFIED ASSUMPTION DRAFT INTERNAL REVIEW: ... APPROVED count: 0

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What this is DRAFT

A go-to-market and operating system for Semester built on what the repository already holds, extended only where something was missing. It has five parts: a master GTM playbook, an in-app financial model, a 15-sequence institutional outreach system, a cloud security and compliance plan, and this report. The existing-versus-missing inventory is in docs/business/INVENTORY.md.

The commercial thesis ASSUMPTION

Two engines. **Institutional revenue:** sell one narrow, measurable workflow, the Registration Readiness Pilot, to a named sponsor for a defined cohort, then convert it to an annual agreement and expand. **Student adoption:** create immediate utility and measure activation, first meaningful action, workflow completion, weekly use and satisfaction, so that measured outcomes become the proof for renewal. Semester is not sold as a replacement for every university system.

What may be done today VERIFIED (GO-NO-GO-DECISION.md , 2026-10-03)

Motion	Decision	Allowed now
Individual students	Conditional GO	Invitation-only, unpaid validation
Design-partner institutional pilot	GO for non-activation work only	Discovery, synthetic demos, evidence exchange, conditional scoping
Paid institutional pilot	NO-GO / RED	Preparation only: no payment, no live data, no launch obligation
Broad enterprise sale	NO-GO / RED	Learning only

Every artifact in this system carries a Gate statement saying what is allowed now and what is held. Nothing here authorises a price, a payment, live data or a customer claim.

What was built VERIFIED

Part	Where	What it is
Finance model	app/src/finance/ , Console Finance model tab	A 36-month engine, 12 scenarios, about 100 validated inputs, two sensitivity matrices, five warnings, five exports; 97 tests; every output labelled a forecast

Part	Where	What it is
GTM documents	docs/business/gtm/	Master playbook (sections A to J), customer-safe version, 90-day plan, KPI tree
Sales system	docs/business/sales/	15 outreach sequences (29 email blocks, each with persona, trigger, action, A/B, CRM record, timing, stop condition, compliance note), discovery script, proposal, action plan, 36 objections, CRM pipeline with a 100-account template
Customer success	docs/business/customer-success/ , templates/	Onboarding workflow, pilot success plan, health score, renewal playbook, eight fill-in templates
Compliance	docs/business/compliance/	Ten consolidated views over docs/trust/ , including a 99-row evidence register with the brief's columns

What the model says ASSUMPTION (Forecast)

At the default assumptions (lean founder-led team, 20 accounts contacted a month, paid pilots from month 7) the Base case reaches about **\$110k ARR in month 36**, never breaks even inside 36 months, and needs about **\$724k of funding** to keep cash at zero. Only the Ambitious scenario breaks even (month 35). The finding is volume: at about three pilots a year the plan does not carry even a lean team. LTV : CAC is about 1.4x on unvalidated retention. Every rate is a placeholder until the first design-partner engagement measures it.

Decisions that need the founder INTERNAL

1. **Pilot length.** Code enforces 26 weeks (D-134); the brief assumes 8 to 12 weeks.
2. **Student price.** D-134 \$7.99 / \$59; D-1154 \$15 per month; the brief \$8.99 / \$69. None is approved.
3. **Institutional price and unit.** Per enrolled student (\$18) versus per active student; the \$30,000 minimum sits between the deal-desk department and campus minimums.
4. **AI pool.** 2,400 requests per student per year may cost more than the platform fee; "request" needs a definition.
5. **Whether and when to price a pilot at all**, given the paid-pilot NO-GO.

Top 10 next actions, in order DRAFT

1. Decide conflicts 1 to 5 and record them as a decision.
2. Engage higher-ed SaaS counsel for pilot paper, DPA and public wording; fix the public 72-hour breach-notice wording first. REVIEW: counsel
3. Engage an accountant and tax adviser and a broker; replace the model's placeholders (opening cash, insurance, accounting, obligations) with quotes. REVIEW: accounting REVIEW: tax REVIEW: insurance
4. Get quotes for the independent security assessment and the accessibility review (go/no-go blockers 2 and 3). REVIEW: security REVIEW: accessibility
5. Correct existing wording that exceeds the claims register: HECVAT draft rows, privacy page, RFP library entries.
6. Build the 100-account list with a recorded reason for outreach on each account, and send sequences 1 to 7 only.
7. Hold 10 discovery calls; record them in the CRM; qualify one design partner.
8. Run a synthetic-data demo and a pilot design session; capture baselines.
9. Name a backup owner and run the first restore and rollback exercise (blockers 6 and 7).
10. Re-run the model monthly with real numbers; start the weekly revenue review.

Evidence state

Repository evidence. The model, tests and documents exist and link to their sources. **Operational evidence.** None: no customer, pilot, outcome, price, certification, assessment, contract or measured financial figure exists. **Missing proof.** See the compliance evidence register and the P0 blockers in the 90-day plan.

Claim ceiling

Internal planning and discussion with professionals and advisers.

Prohibited claims

No customer, outcome, price, forecast, certification, compliance, integration or availability claim, to anyone, on the strength of this document.

Professional review required

REVIEW: counsel pricing, pilot paper, public wording. **REVIEW: accounting** **REVIEW: tax** model treatment. **REVIEW: insurance** coverage.
REVIEW: security **REVIEW: privacy** **REVIEW: accessibility** control and conformance statements. **REVIEW: procurement** how limits are presented.